PAVAN KUMAR NAYAKANTI

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Director-level DevOps and Cloud Platforms leader with 20+ years operating mission-critical, regulated platforms across FinTech and banking (SOX, GDPR). Multi-cloud owner (AWS, Azure, GCP) with hands-on expertise in Kubernetes, Terraform, CI/CD at scale, FinOps, and full-stack observability. Proven track record scaling global SRE organizations from 4 to 40 engineers, embedding compliance-as-code into delivery pipelines (audit trails, approval workflows, change control -- no manual workarounds), and reducing MTTR 40%+ through AIOps-driven automation. Reports to VP and C-suite stakeholders with a track record of translating reliability into business outcomes. Seeking to own the full DevOps and cloud platform charter as a Director, reporting to CTO.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Multi-Cloud Platform Ownership (AWS / Azure / GCP) | Regulated Environment DevOps (SOX, GDPR) | Compliance-as-Code & Audit Trail Automation | Kubernetes & Container Orchestration (CKAD) | CI/CD at Scale & DevSecOps | SRE -- SLOs, On-Call, Blameless Postmortems | FinOps & Cloud Cost Governance | Observability & AIOps | DORA Metrics & Developer Experience | Global Team Building (40+ Engineers) | AI-Assisted Operations | Executive & CTO-Level Stakeholder Management

WORK EXPERIENCE

IRIS Software

Sep 2020 -- Present

Sr. Specialist -- Cloud Practice & SRE Lead | India (Clients: ADP, Charles Schwab, BMO)

- **Compliance-as-Code CI/CD (ADP):** Designed and governed SOX-aligned incident, problem, and change management across multi-client cloud platforms -- enforcing structured RCA workflows, cross-team postmortems, and measurable change success rate improvements. Automated remediation via Ansible and Dynatrace, eliminating manual compliance workarounds.
- **SRE Scale-Up & MTTR Reduction (ADP):** Scaled ADP's SRE organization from 4 to 40 engineers and architects across India, Canada, and the US. Defined SLOs, SLIs, and error budgets; instituted blameless postmortem culture; reduced MTTR by 40%+ through AIOps-driven automated remediation.
- **FinOps & AWS Platform Ownership (BMO):** Led end-to-end on-premise to AWS migration for BMO CCB -- CDK-enabled deployment pipelines across ECS Fargate and Lambda, HA/DR built in from day one. Drove FinOps practices: identified unused and underutilised resources, rightsized workloads, and reduced cloud waste across the full AWS estate.
- **Full-Stack Observability (ADP):** Deployed Prometheus, Grafana, and Dynatrace for full-stack observability -- real-time alerting, root cause analysis, and proactive bottleneck identification. Established Chaos Engineering practices using Keptn; managed on-call rotations and escalation frameworks for a 35-member SRE team.
- **Platform Engineering Build-Out (Charles Schwab):** Built Charles Schwab's 18-member Platform Engineering team from the ground up as IRIS India-side delivery lead -- established SRE practices, reliability reviews, incident governance, and on-call runbooks. Delivered 99.9% release reliability; aligned cross-platform artifact deployment as part of the TD Ameritrade merger integration programme.
- **High-Throughput Deployment Platform (modeas):** Architected and delivered a deployment orchestration platform serving all product domains -- 200+ builds/deployments per hour, containerized via Kubernetes and Helm, IaC-driven. Eliminated 10,000+ manual operational hours annually; accelerated deployment cadence by 600%.
- **GenAI & AI-Assisted Operations (BMO):** Designed and deployed GenAI risk summarisation and Q&A assistants on AWS Bedrock using event-driven pipelines, reducing manual analysis effort and accelerating regulatory insights delivery.

IRIS Software

Jun 2018 -- Sep 2020

Automation Technology Specialist | Toronto, Canada (Client: Royal Bank of Canada Insurance)

- **Compliance-as-Code Pipeline (RBC -- SOX/GDPR):** Engineered audit trails, approval workflows, and change evidence directly into CI/CD pipelines across 250+ applications -- SonarQube, JFrog Artifactory, Jenkins, UrbanCode, and GitHub enforcing SAST/DAST/IAST and SOX/GDPR change control gates. Zero manual compliance workarounds.
- **DORA Framework Adoption:** Inducted DORA across RBC Wealth Management and Insurance via Azure DevOps -- established Deployment Frequency, Lead Time for Changes, Change Failure Rate, and MTTR as primary engineering health metrics reviewed quarterly with VP stakeholders.
- **Self-Service Deployment Framework (Robo Deployment Framework):** Designed a self-service CI/CD orchestration platform enabling release pipelines for Windows services, database deployments (SSIS, Oracle, SQL Server), and enterprise application workloads. Automated artifact retrieval and approval workflows via Python and Ansible. Application onboarding reduced from 5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction).
- Led enterprise migration of 250+ applications across 60+ teams from CA SCM/Harvest to GitHub. Contributed to ~$200K in new project acquisitions through pre-sales and delivery leadership at RBC subsidiaries.

IRIS Software

Feb 2017 -- Jun 2018

Automation Architect | Toronto, Canada (Clients: Insurance & Capital Markets)

- Designed fault-tolerant, container-orchestrated deployment pipelines using Kubernetes and Helm for zero-downtime rollouts across capital markets platforms.
- Led RPA practice delivery automating 80+ applications and 250+ components across heterogeneous stacks (Java, NodeJS, Kafka, Salesforce, Mainframe). Contributed to $478K SOW closure and $180K Capital Markets engagement.

TechMahindra Pvt. Ltd.

Jul 2015 -- Feb 2017

Technology Manager | Noida, India (Client: Adobe)

- Led end-to-end data migration (Informatica to SQL Server 2012), SAP HANA upgrades, and zero-downtime data centre relocation for Adobe -- full plan, execution, and cutover with no production impact.
- Directed cross-functional global engineering teams on large-scale enterprise delivery, aligning infrastructure initiatives with business timelines.

Microsoft Corporation

Jul 2007 -- Dec 2014

Sr. SDET -- QA, Automation & Production Engineering | India

- Full production ownership of Sales & Marketing platforms serving US, EMEA, and APAC subsidiaries -- 99.99% uptime sustained over 7 years. Owned all non-functional objectives (performance, availability, scalability, security) alongside functional quality.
- Built and led QA automation frameworks integrated with CI/CD; managed incident response, RCA, and infrastructure administration (Windows/Linux). Supported 200% user growth with no degradation in platform reliability through cloud migration and self-healing architectures.

KEY PLATFORM INITIATIVES

Compliance-as-Code Pipeline -- RBC (250+ Apps, SOX/GDPR)

SOX -- GDPR -- CI/CD -- DevSecOps

Engineered audit trails, approval workflows, and change evidence directly into CI/CD across 250+ applications at RBC Insurance. SonarQube, JFrog, Jenkins, and UrbanCode enforcing SAST/DAST/IAST and SOX/GDPR gates. Zero manual compliance workarounds. Application onboarding reduced from 5 weeks to 5 hours (98% reduction).

ADP SRE -- MTTR -40%, Blameless Culture, AIOps Remediation

SRE -- SLO -- AIOps -- Dynatrace -- Ansible

Scaled ADP SRE from 4 to 40 engineers. Instituted blameless postmortem culture, automated remediation via Dynatrace and Ansible, and MTTR SLOs visible to C-suite. Deployed Prometheus + Grafana + Dynatrace for full-stack observability. Chaos Engineering via Keptn. MTTR reduced 40%+.

BMO AWS Migration & FinOps

AWS -- CDK -- ECS Fargate -- FinOps -- HA/DR

Led end-to-end on-premise to AWS migration for BMO CCB. CDK-enabled pipelines across ECS Fargate and Lambda with HA/DR built in. FinOps: identified unused resources, rightsized workloads, reduced cloud waste across the AWS estate. GenAI assistants deployed on AWS Bedrock for regulatory insights.

DORA Adoption -- RBC Wealth Management & Insurance

DORA -- Azure DevOps -- Developer Experience

Established DORA as the engineering health standard across 60+ RBC teams via Azure DevOps. Deployment Frequency, Lead Time, Change Failure Rate, and MTTR tracked and reviewed quarterly with VP stakeholders. Measurable improvement in delivery performance and production stability.

EDUCATION

Masters in Artificial Intelligence -- Woolf University 2024

General Management Program (GMP) -- ISB Hyderabad 2022

M.Sc in Computer Science -- Osmania University 2002

B.Sc in Electronics -- Kakatiya University 2000

CERTIFICATIONS

Microsoft Certified: Azure Solutions Architect Expert (AZ-305) 2026

Certified Kubernetes Application Developer (CKAD) 2025

AWS Certified Solutions Architect -- Associate (SAA-C01) 2026

Google Cloud Certified -- Professional Cloud Architect (PCA) 2026

Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Engineer Associate (AI-102)

ITIL® Certificate in IT Service Operations

PMI Agile Certified Professional (PMI-ACP)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Cloud & Platform: AWS (CDK, ECS Fargate, Lambda, Bedrock), Microsoft Azure (AZ-305), GCP (PCA), Kubernetes (CKAD), Docker, Helm, Terraform, Ansible, Azure DevOps

Compliance-as-Code: SOX, GDPR -- audit trail automation, approval workflow pipelines, change control gates, environment segregation (RTB/CTB); ITIL-aligned incident/change/problem management

CI/CD & DevSecOps: GitHub Actions, Jenkins, UrbanCode, SonarQube, JFrog Artifactory, SAST/DAST/IAST scanning, GitOps patterns, shift-left security integration

SRE & Observability: SLIs/SLOs, Error Budgets, Chaos Engineering (Keptn), Prometheus, Grafana, Dynatrace, MS Application Insights, Splunk, Telegraf, DORA metrics

FinOps: AWS cost governance -- resource rightsizing, usage analysis, waste elimination (BMO)

AI & Automation: GenAI (AWS Bedrock, Azure AI), AIOps, MLOps, Python, Go, Bash, PowerShell, Groovy; MSc in Artificial Intelligence; AI-102, DP-100

Data & Integration: SAP HANA, SQL Server, Oracle, SSIS, event-driven pipelines (AWS Bedrock/BCRG), Kafka integration, Tableau, Power BI